



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 17

KANSAS

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Kansas's family courts and child-welfare system.

165

KANSAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 299
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 20 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
MAY 11, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
42 OF 105

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · KANSAS

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Kansas. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

Andrew Bolton

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · MIAMI · 7 FAMILIES

"Hand-picked by Judge Richard Fisher. Refuses to review my evidence. Believes all allegations against me. Won't allow me to choose my own reintegration therapist — required to use his buddy Naomi Catadella. I lost my kids to the REAL abuser and Andy Bolton and Richard Fisher painted me as crazy, took my voice."

"The system allowed my abuser to escape all consequences to the point of his criminal charges being dismissed and helped Dad turning me into the abuser. The system has stripped me of any belief that leaving my abuser was the right choice. I wish I would have stayed — at least I would still have my children."

"Ignored evidence. Did not investigate. Sided with bias due to ex communicating and me going through my lawyer. Literally yelled at me in court, misconduct and the judge even called him out." **FRANKLIN**

"Lied under oath about child's wants." **MIAMI COUNTY**

"Real life con artist" **JOHNSON**

Naomi Cataudella

REUNIFICATION THERAPIST · JOHNSON · 6 FAMILIES

"It is deeply upsetting to revisit and update my survey to include Naomi Catadeulla as one of the court actors in my case. She was the first supervisor assigned to me after my children were taken on January 29, 2024, and my experience with her was confusing, distressing, and ultimately devastating. During our meetings, she gave me constantly shifting and conflicting rules about how I was allowed to behave. I was told I could not cry in front of my children—even though they had just been taken from me without the chance to say goodbye—and that if I did, they would be removed from the visit and I would not be allowed to see them again for two weeks. I was also instructed not to talk about their pets, not to express that I missed them, and to avoid anything that reflected normal, loving emotions between a mother and her children. Before what was supposed to be my final session—just one step away from finally seeing my kids—I asked if I could write down the rules so I could review them with my therapist and ensure I followed everything correctly. She refused to let me have a pen and paper, took my phone so I could not even make notes, and then became upset when I tried to clarify what I had been told. She denied ever saying those things, despite having clearly stated them before. Without warning, she told me she would no longer serve as my supervisor. I begged her to reconsider, explaining that I was so close to being able to see my children, but she refused. I left that meeting in tears, completely broken. That moment was not just an isolated incident—it was the beginning of a pattern that has kept me separated from my children for over two years."

"She hates women. Apparently had a bad mother. She would say she hates working with us. She would give horrible stares downs. She was rude and unprofessional near every session. She believed every single lie from the father in my case because he was charming in sessions. She never solved our issues. She gave a thousand delays and dinners and excuses to the father and was brutally harsh on me." **JOCO**

"Reintegration therapist forced on me by Andy Bolton — described as Bolton's buddy. Located 2.5 hours away from my home. I was required to use her, not allowed to choose my own." **MIAMI**

"Met with me 1 time for 1 hour. Then drafted a report to my detriment. Never saw me with our kids. In my opinion is part of a corrupt system used in Johnson County KS."

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Keven O'Grady**JUDGE · JOHNSON · **4 FAMILIES**

"Ordered removal of my five children without a full hearing, without any witnesses or ever asking me if the allegations were true, and still has not given me a real hearing while I have been separated from my kids for over two years, and requires me to find and pay for supervisors with unrealistic requirements like providing their full case history before he will even set a hearing, which has made it nearly impossible to see my children."

"The court system has taken away my son's mother, my other kids' brother. Kevin O'Grady needs to be exposed — he claims he does things for the kids' safety. No, he breaks families."

"Doesn't do shit. Named alongside attorney Katie McClafin and GAL Andrew Bolton in the conflict that "fucked us all up.""

Randy McCallaGAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · JOHNSON · **4 FAMILIES**

"This is the single biggest trauma of my life. Guardian Ad Litem are the biggest threat to the family court system and their power must be checked. Randy McCalla ambushed me in court in 2013 — a standard custody hearing — claiming my rights needed to be terminated due to parental alienation. He presented no evidence, and I left court shocked and without my kids. Randy didn't allow me to talk to my kids for 5 weeks. He told me in his office that he knew the judge personally as if to imply she would do whatever he wanted. The therapist Randy insisted on using shared an office with him."

"Caused permanent and irreparable harm to my children's mental and physical health as well as to my entire family. Blackmailed by Randy McCalla. Ex parte communication between attorneys and court appointed medical professionals. Falsified court hearings with custody-modifying orders when no hearing ever occurred."

"Filed the emergency motion that led to my children being taken, never spoke to me, and instead worked with my ex, his attorney, therapists, and DCF while leaving me completely out and continuing to push for me to stay separated from my kids."

Bud DaleCUSTODY EVALUATOR · SHAWNEE · **3 FAMILIES**

"I hired him initially to be my attorney for divorce and child custody. I want to try to get my money back from Bud Dale. He collected the retainer and never did anything. I even had to submit ALL paperwork twice because he lost it! Had to hire other counsel because he disappeared and kept my \$. He never filed the paperwork he was hired to and missed crucial deadlines which harmed my child. After creating a much bigger mess. He is not who he portrays on his website is not what he practices. He is a fraud. He never provided itemized billing for my retainer he took and then disappeared."

"Makes personal opinion to form decision making. Does not hold parties to the court order/allows unilateral decision making. Creates hostile environment; cussing. Challenges the party as if on trial. Mocked the capabilities of my child's spelling ability. Attempted to discourage a legitimate report being made on a crime as that would make coparenting "more difficult"."

"Refused to allow myself or my attorney to submit evidence to him. He refused it, after learning he met with me as counsel 9 months prior. He then retaliated after my attorney exposed his behavior on the record. He was then replaced the next day."

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Dan Livingston

REUNIFICATION THERAPIST · JOHNSON · 3 FAMILIES

"Has had counseling with my daughters for eight months and will not listen to them that they do not want to return to 50% custody with their father and says that they have to go back and otherwise they have to keep coming to him. My girls have told Dan that they know that Dan lies, and Dan minimize their problems that they are addressing... And that he only sides with the father. He has made a point that only stepmother is a problem and that that's going to be fixed. He does not believe the girls issues and has told case management that there's enough alienation from my part that they don't trust anything the girls have said or that I have said. He rolls his eyes back in his head, and does this weird expression when he doesn't like what somebody is saying. It's been seen enough times that people laugh about it. My daughters have a friend who they have ran into at his Counseling and they have all discussed conversations that none of them like him because he doesn't listen to the girls, and he only sides with the fathers. Any female is to not be listened to, and only the men's point of view matters." JOCO

"Was assigned to help restore contact with my kids but allowed my ex to keep them from sessions, canceled visits over payment, made me spend over \$5,000 before I could even see them, I spent over \$10,000 total, and then he suddenly dropped me based on what my ex said, which stopped reunification completely."

Heather Landon

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · JOHNSON · 3 FAMILIES

"Shows extreme bias based on if she knows the parties representatives. Does not put the child first. Ignores abuse claims due to the personal relationship she has with council."

"Earlier GAL on the case. Continued to force the children into reintegration therapy even though the DA said it would taint the criminal case against the father." MIAMI

"Withdrew from case. Violated rights, handled issues for ex during hearings, failed to meet with children and me"

Katie McClaflin

ATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · JOHNSON · 3 FAMILIES

"Represented opposing party and advanced positions supporting continued restriction of my parenting time and separation from my children."

"She clearly advised her client to lie and avoid accountability for misleading the court."

"Named alongside Judge Keven O'Grady and GAL Andrew Bolton."

William F. Ebert III

OTHER · SHAWNEE COUNTY · 3 FAMILIES

"Audited 200 cases by his bar number. Discovered a significant pattern of cases the children were being harmed. In the audits I also discovered he is sending his cases he has as a GAL/Case Manager/Conciliator to a specific therapist that lost their license in NE for sexual misconduct with patients. However in KS Mr. Ebert is subjecting people to use this therapist. Discovered overwhelming evidence he has been misleading the judges for years providing false information. Exploiting children to chaos for profit. Most of his case he was appointed to got much worse and prolonged for years once he got involved."

"He had been actively representing opposing counsel since 2 months prior to being appointed as my domestic conciliator, at the recommendation of opposing counsel and has since switched primary residential custody and then terminated my parenting time without due process."

"Delayed reunification, false allegations were known and proven and still tried to convince judge otherwise."

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

KANSAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 165 Kansas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 299 162 of 165 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$75,400 median across 81 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 20 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 54.5% 44.2% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 165	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.8	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 162 of 165	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 42

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Kansas families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

03 THE COST OF KANSAS FAMILY COURT

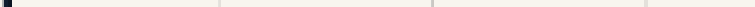
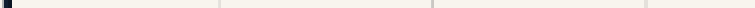
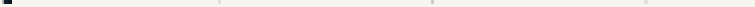
Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

Expense Category	Responses	Median	Mean	Total Reported
Attorney Fees	102	\$17,500	\$50,089	\$5,109,053
Lost Wages	88	\$10,000	\$43,875	\$3,860,961
Other Court Fees	58	\$1,100	\$4,176	\$242,192
Therapy / Evaluations	74	\$2,000	\$4,909	\$363,300
Reunification Services	61	\$200	\$3,152	\$192,260
GAL Fees	74	\$2,750	\$7,286	\$539,131
Asset Loss ¹	67	\$30,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (81 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$75,400	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$30,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance: median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		20	1.7 yrs
Mean months lost		33	2.8 yrs
Total across all families		3,502	291.8 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · KANSAS

Most families documenting in Kansas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		75	45%
Case closed: within last 2 years		29	18%
Not provided		27	16%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		16	10%
Not in court but still affected		7	4%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		72	44%
Both Family Court and CPS		62	38%
Unknown		16	10%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		12	7%
Family Court		3	2%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		37	22%
5 – 10 years		36	22%
Over 10 years		27	16%
3 – 5 years		21	13%
6 months – 1 year		13	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		53	32%
50/50 Joint		37	22%
Visitation Only		34	21%
Full Custody		14	8%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		14	8%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Johnson		35	21%
Shawnee		16	10%
Sedgwick		7	4%
Miami		6	4%
Lyon		4	2%
Osage		2	1%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		47	28%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		24	15%
Other: (Short answer)		17	10%
High Conflict Divorce		15	9%
Other		13	8%

05 PARENT VOICES — KANSAS

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Kansas comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



This case has ripped my family apart. It has destroyed our home, my life, the lives of my children, the lives of my parents, the lives of every family member, the lives of everyone that I loved. This case has destroyed our whole entire town. It has destroyed everything that I've [...]

— CHRISTY

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

It didn't just take my 5 kids—it took birthdays, holidays, and the everyday moments that make a family. We've been forced to live in a nightmare of silence, separation, and trauma that never should have happened. This system protected court insiders and unchecked power instead of [...]

— KANSAS PARENT · MEGHANN

MORE VOICES FROM KANSAS

The Kansas court system is so corrupt. It's not even funny and judge Mativi is my judge. She awarded custody to someone who had no witnesses when I had five witnesses saying he smoked marijuana with my kids in the room and abused me and the children.

— CIERRA

They almost broke me, they took my kids, forced me to leave my husband alienated us individually. And then when I kept fighting they used threats and coercion to force me out of my kids lives. I fought against corruption, abuse of power and trafficking, and lost. I survived but [...]

— DESIREE

My kids are traumatized from being ripped away from who was their primary caregiver their entire lives for zero valid reason, and I am forever changed because of the abuse I've endured through this process.

— TAYLOR

Systematically destroyed and traumatized my daughter. Set her up to go into an abusive relationship. My daughter wrote the judge a personal letter, called dcf, and reported her fathers abuse to the police twice. She was totally ignored and forced to remain with her psychopathic [...]

— SATAH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It's legalized extortion- judicial mafia- attorneys and judges are all in on it. Casa, CPS and local pd - no one really cares- inept and unprofessional

— KELLY

Corrupt judges, attorneys and other court appointed professionals abused their position to extort money from my family by issuing orders and directives for the sole purpose of causing harm to my children. These officers of the Court are intentionally committing crimes for the [...]

— MIKE

The system has allowed my abuser to continue to have access to me and my financials years after escaping and being no contact. The judge has ordered more financial harm regardless of proof. She's even ordered me to do things that significantly negatively impact my children that [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My kids and I have separation anxiety we have to do a lot of Mental Health more than we ever had in our life bad things has happened to my oldest daughter while in custody my family will never be the same we will never get that time back that they messed up on we have lost out [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It is called KIDNAPPING children from the parents and grandparents without visitation rights has caused Me and My Family POST TRAUMATIC STRESS UNCUREABLE

— ANGELA

The system is failing my daughter by dismissing abuse claims because the opposing attorney knows our GAL and it seems our GAL is unable to remain unbiased. My case is one sided and leaning always toward dad. What's best for the children is no longer what the system is going off [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My exhusband had criminal charges for taking the life of our unborn child through DV and would not allow my daughter to get me medical help. He was charged for 1 misdemeanor (domestic battery) and 1 felony charge (intimidation of a minor) in 2022. GAL Heather Landon was on the [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It's just corrupt. Don't want to say more than that. But that judge is no good.

— HANNA

My life has been destroyed by family courts stealing my child with false allegations. I no longer own a home or have a place to live.

— ROBERT

My children's childhood was stolen from them. They were taken on false allegations over 3 years. Which were all determined unsubstantiated- they still have not returned home. They have been withheld court ordered therapy treatment for 3 years with no enforcement that could help [...]

— MEL

My life revolves around soul crushing court ordered abuse. My child has been legally kidnapped to our abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

In the process of going through this I became very very depressed I don't trust anyone I never sleep I used to own a company that I wanted to have as a family business and I was doing great now I can barely focus on even stepping out the back door or the front door of my house [...]

— JOE

I was part of a government sting where I lured in to a hotel recommended by an ex to where I was unknowingly monitored and surveillanced followed by gang stalking and multiple attempts of trying to set me up. This system has mentally, emotionally, and spiritually damaged my [...]

— BRITTANY

It had destroyed my children's mental health and mine. My youngest has become suicidal, which is everyday.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This devastating case has caused immense emotional and irrepitable damage to our Grandchildren and our entire family.

— JODEE

The system created an environment that allowed my children to think their mother abused them and did want them. I have one child that calls me by my first name. The court said my ex could do whatever he wanted. And he did. They helped him in every way they could

— TRACEY

Lost custody due to not having representation at all,, and the judge not bothering to investigate the false claims. I never even got a chance to speak or give evidence.

— TRISH

The system recognizes the abuser then gives your children to them. The system is used to continue to control and abuse Domestic Violence Survivors, and to retraumatize them repeatedly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My Grandmother (whom i was living with) died of a heartattack the day they came and took my daughter, while she was lying there dying she kept saying "dont let the paramedics see you here taking care of your daughter" (they gave me one hour to move out of my house that day. My [...]

— TIFFANY

All I do is cry. Not because I am hurting. Because of the unimaginable pain my children are in with out me. They barely had a childhood between their father killing his self in front of us (me and the twins at 3 years old) and being ripped away from mommy at 7 and a half years.

— TINA

The system has destroyed our lives

— MATTHEW

Failed to protect me and my children who are victims of a crime, Level 7 and level 10 felony, Expects money in return for justice.

— COREY

Caused my children trauma and placed them with my abusive ex husband.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Ripped up apart. Made us broke & homeless. Every time I try they knock me down. They never say a good thing about me or anything I do or have done. The judge said she wasn't comfortable letting me keep my kids. There was lies made up about me & i love my kids very much and im [...]

— JASMYN

I was put through EXTREME STRESS, and was always warned what I could or couldn't say to the kids. I did suffer health issues!!!!

— MONICA

Gaslighted and emotionally abused my family.

— KIMBERLEE

Stole my kids and never helped me get the resources or support they are promising families to reintegrate.

— LISA

Cause depression, loss of time and mental abuse on siblings and family members

— ANNETTA

Deprived my son and I of our God given rights as a father and son

— JOHN

After dealing with Lewanna Bell-Lloyd, and CPS, it proved to me there's no "justice" in the justice system.

— PAUL

Taken a good quality mother away from her children due to the father not wanting to pay child support. Father has made multiple false allegations, called cps, and stalked and harassed me from day one.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Never, in the history of humanity, have children had their medical, educational, adjudicative, due process and administrative needs met by a series of portals and videoconferences set up entirely in response to a pandemic that has long passed. Children are being sold back to [...]

— SHAWN

Ripped us apart and stole my children's chances at a happy healthy childhood and adulthood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family Court does not have fiduciary representation for the members of high-cost attorneys. The Attorneys collaborate with Judges and Social Workers for their firms best interest. Not the actual client.

— ANDREW

111 Kansas parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 40 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — KANSAS

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Kansas families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

This case has ripped my family apart. It has destroyed our home, my life, the lives of my children, the lives of my parents, the lives of every family member, the lives of everyone that I loved. This case has destroyed our whole entire town. It has destroyed everything that I've worked for. Has ruined my work reputation and everything that I work so hard my whole entire life for. My home is physically devastated. I am financially devastated. And everything that is written in the court is based on all false accusations that have completely been disproven and the whole case is legally null and void in all five counties. It truly is based completely on fruit of the poisonous tree from the very second the concept completely started. And the fact that I have to go to the United States federal court system to undo what a criminal was allowed to do to my family the fact that any criminal can go into anyone's home and be able to tear up someone's life based on hearsay and fraud at any given point and our law enforcement agency just stands by and does nothing about it something is so broken in the United States that that is allowed to happen. That is not the country that are forefathers built the Constitution of the United States on. Where is are God given rights of Protection in this Country??

— CHRISTY

The Kansas court system is so corrupt. It's not even funny and judge Mativi is my judge . She awarded custody to someone who had no witnesses when I had five witnesses saying he smoked marijuana with my kids in the room and abused me and the children.

— CIERRA

It didn't just take my 5 kids—it took birthdays, holidays, and the everyday moments that make a family. We've been forced to live in a nightmare of silence, separation, and trauma that never should have happened. This system protected court insiders and unchecked power instead of protecting children and due process. It stripped my parental rights without proof, then kept the separation going through delays, restrictions, and retaliation.

— MEGHANN

They almost broke me, they took my kids, forced me to leave my husband alienated us individually. And then when I kept fighting they used threats and coercion to force me out of my kids lives. I fought against corruption, abuse of power and trafficking, and lost. I survived but I only made it out with my youngest son because I saw what they would try to do and was a step ahead, now we're forever running. They can't quiet me, should my children come looking for me later in life I want to ensure they find that I never gave up, never stopped fighting for them.

— DESIREE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My kids are traumatized from being ripped away from who was their primary caregiver their entire lives for zero valid reason, and I am forever changed because of the abuse I've endured through this process.

— TAYLOR

Systematically destroyed and traumatized my daughter. Set her up to go into an abusive relationship. My daughter wrote the judge a personal letter, called dcf, and reported her fathers abuse to the police twice. She was totally ignored and forced to remain with her psychopathic abusive father.

— SATAH

It's legalized extortion- judicial mafia- attorneys and judges are all in on it. Casa, CPS and local pd - no one really cares- inept and unprofessional

— KELLY

Corrupt judges, attorneys and other court appointed professionals abused their position to extort money from my family by issuing orders and directives for the sole purpose of causing harm to my children. These officers of the Court are intentionally committing crimes for the sole purpose of stealing money from broken families and these crimes are routinely and consistently committed by the same individuals. The Johnson County Kansas family court system is a cesspool full of narcissistic and incestuous behavior by these so-called officers of the Court.

— MIKE

The system has allowed my abuser to continue to have access to me and my financials years after escaping and being no contact. The judge has ordered more financial harm regardless of proof. She's even ordered me to do things that significantly negatively impact my children that I'm the primary care giver for with no support system. One child with special needs. She doesn't care. He's lied and contradicted himself many times demanding harm to me which should be a red flag for coercive control and a need for power and control. To hear that what's being demanded would be harmful to my children and he pushed for it knowing it doesn't affect him shows incredible desire to cause more harm. Significant lack of empathy. Even an attorney recognized this person isn't seeking resolution, he seeking to cause harm. It's obvious but the judge refuses to see it and has become his tool since he lost access to me any other way.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My kids and I have separation anxiety we have to do a lot of Mental Health more than we ever had in our life bad things has happened to my oldest daughter while in custody my family will never be the same we will never get that time back that they messed up on we have lost out on times as a family my children were abused while in foster care DCF knew about it kvc knew about it and they tried to cover it up which they did I was told my kids are better off without me I got silenced because I always showed up with proof yet still got denied to bring it up at times or it was irrelevant they said I was told let my kids have a voice because I always speak for my children and I because a lot of times they were scared to speak up in front of them at court so I did that for them attorneys g a l prosecutors nobody cares because it wasn't them and their family going through this

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

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— MEL

My life revolves around soul crushing court ordered abuse. My child has been legally kidnapped to our abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

In the process of going through this I became very very depressed I don't trust anyone I never sleep I used to own a company that I wanted to have as a family business and I was doing great now I can barely focus on even stepping out the back door or the front door of my house I've lost my so-called license to drive been in jail many times been beat up in jail by the COS my phone's been hacked by the county of Osage or the state of Kansas I found out through guardio it's difficult for me to focus to work I've gone broke my house is falling apart Nothing in life is the way it should be I don't even get to call my kids for one minute each once per year to say I love you I get nothing they changed my kids' names and my girls they even change their first names I've been put in jail for trying to contact the cop lady who adopted my kids via messenger she told me to stop so I stopped however she still pressed charges on me and the judge still put me in jail been a while after that they put false drug charges on me I did almost a year by the miracle of God I was let out after 7 months just before Thanksgiving the whole time in the beginning the first couple years I was so stressed out and so depressed my health failed I was dying from it I had a small stroke and I started having thyroid issues my skin was falling off me my legs are so swollen they felt like they're going to burst I know I was within inches of death broken heart disease yeah that's a real one too I experienced it I still am

— JOE

I was part of a government sting where I lured in to a hotel recommended by an ex to where I was unknowingly monitored and surveillanced followed by gang stalking and multiple attempts of trying to set me up. This system has mentally, emotionally, and spiritually damaged my children and I due to false accusations. They separated my son from his brother and sister after termination of my rights during Covid. And after being coerced by a local non profit organization that they were on my side and would be my support while still involved with the system after having my twins, I gave them temporary guardian while I continued treatment and therapy and obtaining employment. After 7 months everything the testified under oath in court to helping me succeed they did complete opposite and had people come into my life to make me fail and moved to termination.

— BRITTANY

It had destroyed my children's mental health and mine. My youngest has become suicidal, which is everyday.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This devastating case has caused immense emotional and irrepitable damage to our Grandchildren and our entire family.

— JODEE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system created an environment that allowed my children to think their mother abused them and did want them. I have one child that calls me by my first name. The court said my ex could do whatever he wanted. And he did. They helped him in every way they could

— TRACEY

Lost custody due to not having representation at all,, and the judge not bothering to investigate the false claims. I never even got a chance to speak or give evidence.

— TRISH

The system recognizes the abuser then gives your children to them. The system is used to continue to control and abuse Domestic Violence Survivors, and to retraumatize them repeatedly.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My Grandmother (whom i was living with) died of a heartattack the day they came and took my daughter, while she was lying there dying she kept saying "dont let the paramedics see you here taking care of your daughter" (they gave me one hour to move out of my house that day. My Son was given back to his abusive father at the same time and had to grow up without his sister, hes since been given back to me but i was forced to sign my rights away after i was lied to and offered no help as the pandemic took all resources away for awhile, I may have dabbled with drugs a little but i was not a junkie, i was not using a needle or heroin, i had a full time job and took care of my kids better than anyone else in this world could, they needed for nothing, she never even had a diaper rash while with me, we had a nice house, there was NO reason they should have deemed me unfit because i failed their drug tests they tricked me with and then took my precious baby, at 3 months old, how could any human being sit in that cold chair and watch a mothers heart break literally in two for a stone cold paycheck, a woman who by-the-way was morbidly obese (a lifestyle choice she makes) to the point i dont see her taking care of herself let alone the child she was about to have, how could she give that child the care it takes to keep up with all a baby and then toddler require if she cant even do it for herself, bc of a life decision she was making, the same as we all do when we decide to do whatever it is that we shouldnt be doing, it DOESNT always make us unfit parents, granted i can see the stigma as a lot of people give drugs a bad name lol im not justifying them but ok i know im guilty of the

— TIFFANY (1/2)

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

run on sentence so i wont even finish that thought but you can prob. guess the excuse i was getting ready to give there lol thanks for listening

— TIFFANY (2/2)

All I do is cry. Not because I am hurting. Because of the unimaginable pain my children are in with out me. They barely had a childhood between their father killing his self in front of us (me and the twins at 3 years old) and being ripped away from mommy at 7 and a half years.

— TINA

The system has destroyed our lives

— MATTHEW

Failed to protect me and my children who are victims of a crime, Level 7 and level 10 felony, Expects money in return for justice.

— COREY

Caused my children trauma and placed them with my abusive ex husband.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ripped up apart. Made us broke & homeless. Every time I try they knock me down. They never say a good thing about me or anything I do or have done. The judge said she wasn't comfortable letting me keep my kids. There was lies made up about me & i love my kids very much and im just heartbroken..

— JASMYN

I was put through EXTREME STRESS, and was always warned what I could or couldn't say to the kids. I did suffer health issues!!!!

— MONICA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Gaslighted and emotionally abused my family.

— KIMBERLEE

Stole my kids and never helped me get the resources or support they are promising families to reintegrate.

— LISA

Cause depression, loss of time and mental abuse on siblings and family members

— ANNETTA

Deprived my son and I of our God given rights as a father and son

— JOHN

After dealing with Lewanna Bell-Lloyd, and CPS, it proved to me there's no "justice" in the justice system.

— PAUL

Taken a good quality mother away from her children due to the father not wanting to pay child support. Father has made multiple false allegations, called cps, and stalked and harassed me from day one.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Never, in the history of humanity, have children had their medical, educational, adjudicative, due process and administrative needs met by a series of portals and videoconferences set up entirely in response to a pandemic that has long passed. Children are being sold back to their own parents, most of whom have no failed drug tests, no findings of incompetence, and no criminal histories, by a series of tele-lawyers, tele-judges, tele-doctors, tele-social workers and tele-GALS who are using their licenses, wealth and influence to run what is essentially a lucrative human trafficking racket under the guise of law.

— SHAWN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Ripped us apart and stole my children's chances at a happy healthy childhood and adulthood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Family Court does not have fiduciary representation for the members of high-cost attorneys. The Attorneys collaborate with Judges and Social Workers for their firms best interest. Not the actual client.

— ANDREW

System has broken us financially and my children's mental health, depleted resilience, created distrust

— JOANNA

I fought for my children with everything I had in me. I followed every rule, met every demand, jumped through every hoop they placed in front of me, but all they did was move the finish line. The system was never built on fairness, it is built on power. And when you stand against it, they will do anything to bury it. They are untouchable, hiding behind procedures while breaking the very family it claims to protect. It took my voice piece by piece, until I no longer recognized myself. It drained my strength, my hope, my will to keep going. Losing a child to the system like this isn't just loss, it's erasure. It's being told that your love, your effort, your truth... wasn't enough. But I know what I did. I know how hard I fought. And even if the system refused to see it, that fight was real. That love IS real. And no system, no matter how corrupt or powerful, can take that truth away from me. I will never stop fighting.

— ALI

Taken away time together we can never get back. Make my children and I feel we had no control or voice

— SHAE

Turned my children against me we don't talk they have no respect for me I don't get to see grandbaby's nothing

— JENNIFER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Devastated..given me a drive to shut it down. The kids are a close friend of mine.

— KEVIN

They have ripped apart my family , my heart is still broken it has been years they were taken as we were passing through Kansas from Kentucky. My family is in kentucky we are all separated

— MELISSA

It has destroyed my family. My daughter is in a abusive environment begging to come home.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Robbed memories, broken my family apart, and turned my kids against me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system and those in it s have systematically and meticulously destroyed the relationship I had with my son and the relationship between siblings based upon nothing more than their personal biases

— ALETHEA

I have lost my children, filed bankruptcy, and lost my career due to ongoing litigation rooted in coercive control and manipulation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system removed my children without due process, ignored evidence that cleared me, and created financial and procedural barriers that have kept me separated from them for years. The court actors built a system where I have to pay thousands just to try to be their mom again.

— MEGHANN

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The have kidnapped my visatation and my ex has done the same

— JOHN

Missing out out on my kids whole youth years. Ill never get the time back.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was the primary caretaker for my children prior to divorce, post divorce we had 50/50 custody and time. She stalked me, controlled schedules, and manipulated the situation because she is the “mother” and she wanted control so took me back to court over things that could have been a discussion. She committed perjury, manipulated stories on the stand and her and her witnesses made me out to be a terrible father. Now I only get to see my kids every other weekend and pay a crazy amount of child support that I can’t afford. My attorney didn’t stand up for me at all, and proved she lied on the stand. I followed all court documents and mediated agreements but was turned around on me in court.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatized my son to the point he begs for me & says he doesn't like Daddy.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have taken my child and everything i owned. Im living witjout power and water

— DUSTIN

What was suppose to be a short weekend visit turned into months of separation from my daughter,even though there were no finding of abuse or neglect. The time and memories lost between parent and child are something that no system or courts can ever truly give back. I am sharing my experience in hopes that situations like this recieve more transparency and accountability so other families do not lose time with their children the way I did.

— LINDSEY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system allowed my abuser to escape all consequences to the point of his criminal charges being dismissed and helped Dad turning me into the abuser. The system has stripped me of any belief that leaving my abuser was the right choice. I wish I would have stayed, at least I wpuld still have my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court system has taken Away my son's mother my other kids brother Kevin o Grady needs to be exposed he claims he does things for the kids safety no he breaks families

— EMILY

Have my child to their abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has ripped apart my family and caused a divide. It caused half of my family to want nothing to do with me due to their lies.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It taken away most of my past 20 years and will always.

— ANNIE

Destroyed a family because of someone's feelings with no evidence to substantiate claims

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

they altered photos, lied on the stand, ignored facts, and told me to be quiet when I tried to prove their lies. my son was failing all classes, not taking meds, quit wrestling and was eventually sent with paternal family states away but "in my custody still" with no rights whatsoever

— HILLARY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has severely effected my son getting the proper care he needs which has cost him everything in his development

— CURTIS

This the single biggest trauma of my life. Guardian Ad Litem are the biggest threat to the family court system and their power must be checked.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Kept me from seeing my children and all me to parent them

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I havent seen my kids in 3+ years. The court enabled alienation and swept a court ordered report under rug which showed signs of alienation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Complete and total devastation and torment.

— MEGAN

It has caused permanent damage to my children. Our bond is severely affected.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has internally killed me and stolen motherhood from me. I have 2 other children that are also heavily impacted both financially and emotionally.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This case transferred after 10 years and once the new county took over it has systematically broken the bond to irreparable damage. The children's childhood was stolen being forced to court hearings and being subjected to lawyers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I'm a survivor of domestic violence. My 2 abusive exes constantly made false allegations against me. CASA ignored the mountains of evidence that I had. I lost my kids due to false allegations and CASA. DCF knew all the reports were false and had no concerns with me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Caused my kids and ptsd that they still suffer from, depression, they are absolutely terrified of the cops and dcf anytime any of these people are around my kids have behaviors and become vital sick.

— SUSAN

For over a decade the system has used my struggle as a now single mother of 6, living in poverty, recieving no child support....into a sort of financial status discrimination act. Making me appear to be unfit to parent my own children and all because im poor. Making it appear as though I am guilty of emotionally neglecting my kids. My kids are my proof in the pudding.....healthy, thriving, happy, loving, strong persevering, smart, school aged children. Proving money doesn't make you an automatic good parent! I stand with Meg! Shantel

— SHANTEL

Family Court has done nothing but destroy my once happy little family by handing total control over to our abusers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has cut me out of my daughter's life and have manipulated her and turned her against me and have handed her over to her pedophile father who never wanted anything to do with her and only wants her now for her disability check and he has already committed tax fraud by claiming her on his taxes! St Francis needs shut down and the whole system needs to be changed and new people hired! I have lost everything! My daughter was my whole world and I was just trying to get her the help for her mental illness that she so desperately needs!

— APRIL

My daughter being in the KVC foster care system cause further trauma for her and for our family. It place her in direct danger, lack of counseling, medical neglect, financial burden, and stress.

— HEATHER

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Ruined my entire life. And my innocent child's life.

— ALYSSA

Over the course of years, this system has forced me to expend extraordinary financial, emotional, and physical resources to protect my children from ongoing harm, while repeatedly allowing noncompliance, delay, and manipulation to continue unchecked. The result has been severe economic loss, instability, and trauma for both me and my children, despite my consistent efforts to follow court orders and secure their safety and care.

— NICOLE

When systems meant to protect children fail to conduct a full and fair investigation and rely on biased recommendations, the result is devastating. My children are struggling emotionally, and I live with the daily pain of being separated from them despite having been their primary caregiver.

— JESSICA

This system had denied me and my children of not only the present, but also the future. The psychological damaged can not be undone and will effect the future generations of me and my children.

— RACQUEL

Destroyed my son mentally and emotionally, rubbed him of a childhood. I'm on 4 different anxiety meds, heart failure, autistic immune disease, debilitating depression. I trust no one, don't sleep, we both live in constant fear and anxiety

— KELLY

The system has determined that I am only worth a paycheck, to my ex, as a mother.

— TONYA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Court assigned officials in JoCo are not all fit. There MUST be a way for the very people this system is intended to “benefit” to have feedback of providers. Checks and balances of providers should be visible and traceable. JoCo is very much pro-white man privilege. Men are rewarded for providing a fraction of effort (time and money) compared to the expectation of women. Women are held to such a very different standard. Any emotion is considered to make us unreliable and crazy when really we are so exhausted from the very system not listening and changing judges or changing court assigned officials to the highest paid attorney’s demands. Men are not held accountable in family courts at JoCo. They just aren’t.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Exparte order for protection and my ex extended it to my daughter making her not available

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I now have no trust in the family court system. I fear every time I communicate with the other party that it will be used against me and twisted. I feel as though I’m one step away from being taken back into that nightmare every day over false allegations.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken away mental, physical, financial from our family due to the racketeering.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was granted full custody of my children and now paternal grandmother has manipulated the courts to believing they are better off with her. Decisions were made off of feelings and not actual law!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Have financial ruined us tore my business up black ball me from working and has moved my kid 4 hours away from me. Kept my husband and me separated . Our lives have been turned upside down

— ALICIA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Its broke me of my trust in people and has come between our kids and their father. Our kids come running to me and dont wanna leave (besides our youngest he's a mommas boy lol hes always happy to see mom). Its made me reevaluate every decision I make in fear of something being used to keep me from the kids again.

— ANTHONY

Protect the parent that emotionally harms and attempts to alienate our children because their hate for me is greater than their love for our children. Our counsel, the judge, nor case manager will enforce the court order allowing said parent to continue to violate without consequence, which allows ongoing emotional / financial harm and conflict with not only the other parent, but the children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Daily fear of being targeted and controlled in our abusers favor, with no way to defend myself or our son causing extream emotional issues and dissociation ruining my will to live.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have not cared about my sons medical conditions and to special needs. They did not look at evidence that one parent to the primary parents is taking care of all these medical needs into appointments. They only care about 5050 custody and not about looking at the fax. These poor children are being put in situations because of neglectful judges.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Substantial emotional, stigmatized and financial harm beyond repair..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated all the kids from siblings , lost employment from multiple court cases even in the same week and haveing to miss work with mandatory contract hours. Judge refused via zoom ..lost transportation at one point couldnt afford the payment and we are currently going to loose our home that we own bc of lost wages .

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This whole thing has completely ripped my family apart. This neighbor has been a town bully and has financially drained our town and as financially drained my family he has 43 cases in the Cherokee County Court System and I'm the one with the injunction against me he is a professional career Criminal and people just tell me to keep taking it because nothing will ever change.

— CHRISTY

The court has enabled parental alienation and prioritized revenue over genuine reunification and my family's well-being. They have allowed the other household to undermine my children's physical and emotional health, and now the GAL and others are making claims that my ALL BOY, Avengers LEGO-loving son really wants to be a girl.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

"This system didn't just fail us, it chewed us up on a clerical mistake, treated fiction like fact, and called it justice while my family paid in time, money, and sanity. We weren't convicted by evidence, we were processed by indifference."

— SHAWN

I thought the family court system was designed to help families in time of need. I quickly learned that people of power that wear black robes forget what their actual job is. I have lost all faith in that system and will continue to stand against them until they earn my respect or actually do their job. I didn't choose divorce, but I had to accept it. What I will not accept is the fraudulent court system taking my time, money, and right to raise my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Made me lose complete faith in the system . Favorite quote is the system isn't broken. It's rigged. It sure the he'll is. And it's hurting our children in so many ways that can't be measured by data alone.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They made records public so people could see what I did. Violation of privacy

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Instead of protecting my children, this system has enabled disruption, ignored critical concerns, and created outcomes that have damaged our family's stability, trust, and long-term well-being. The family court system has fractured my family across three cases, replacing stability with conflict and allowing inconsistent decisions and broken processes to erode my children's relationships, security, and trust.

— MEAGAN

I never imagined a system meant to protect children could separate them from the only home and parent they had known for over a decade. The emotional and financial toll on our family has been devastating.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I was bullied, slandered, abused, gaslit and lost custody not based on my character, finances, background, parenting skills, being safe, history of primary caregiver but because they had more family support than I did.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My family and life were ripped apart to keep USD 232 from consequences, and the lies told by multiple bad actors only impact me since there is no accountability for them. The only evidence available is the same evidence that would exonerate me but it would require unbiased court actors to look at it that way.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has torn my family apart, and created so much fear in my body that I now am on an antipsychotic medication just to be able to function in society because my PTSD and Depression/Anxiety are sometimes too much to handle.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

After a long tedious divorce process that was finalized in 2023, I was thrilled to finally put it behind me. I asked for 50/50 custody and no child support (although the court enforced \$200/month from my ex). He was insidiously infiltrating our sons mind though and before I knew it, my own son was completely against me insisting to me during our time together he wants to live with his father and that I was clearly an incompetent mother, etc. In 2024 my ex filed a motion for full custody using outlandish allegations against me. Shortly after and without my knowledge he filed for emergency custody with no evidence or due process that same day the judge signed the order. It's been a year now since I've been able to see my son and have yet to have one hearing.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Every bit of joy in my life, is what they took from me. I get told all the time, I wish the old you would come back and sadly, that person no longer exists. My children have been robbed of so many memories that they could have made with not only myself, but their little cousins that they were so excited about, a very special bond my daughter and sister had since the day she was born (more than 10 yrs ago) my son of having a father to raise him and a relationship with their grandparent. It's forever changed my whole family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Shown a child that the abscent parent doesnt have to be responsible for that child and the state will happily pay that abscent parent to care for the child after removed from the sole custodial parent.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I lost a dearly beloved member of my family; my mother in lost the only grandchild she had. I suffered a loss of income that ultimately led to eviction from an apartment and the lies spread caused a significant hit to my reputation. I am now filing bankruptcy. I had to undergo forensic police questioning for the grossest of crimes - and that's a mental scar I cannot erase.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

111 full approved Kansas comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Kansas report comes from Kansas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Kansas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 165 Kansas families reporting here are not the universe of Kansas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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